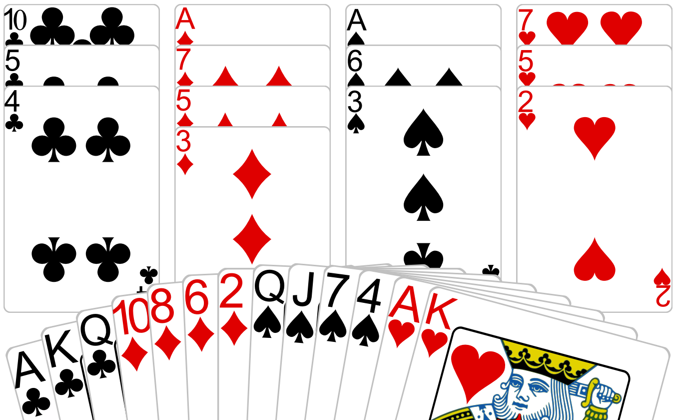
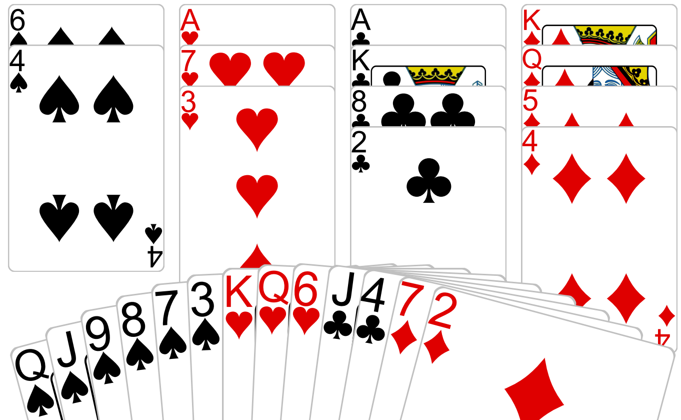
Deal 1 Ctr: **3NT** Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Develop Winners			
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play

Deal 3 Ctr: **4♠** Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Reduce Losers			
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT
Declarer: North

Board: 3
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: East

Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ Q J 7 4 ♥ A K ♦ 10 8 6 2 ♣ A K Q	
♠ K 10 9 8 ♥ 9 6 3 ♦ Q J 4 ♣ 9 7 2	N W E S	♠ 5 2 ♥ Q J 10 8 4 ♦ K 9 ♣ J 8 6 3
	♠ A 6 3 ♥ 7 5 2 ♦ A 7 5 3 ♣ 10 5 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♦	Pass	2♦
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by North

With 19 points you are too strong to open 1NT so you open 1♦. Partner responds 2♦.

Perhaps you can make 5♦. But 9 tricks are easier than 11 so you bid 3NT. Notice that there was no reason to "show" your ♠ suit. If partner held 4 ♠s he would not have bid 2♦.

North plays 3NT. East leads the ♥Q.

North plays 3NT. East leads the ♥Q.

Winners: ♠ 1 : ♥ 2 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 3 : Total = 7

You can create one winner in ♦s if they split 3-2, but too late, the defense would have set up their ♥s. So you must get 2 more ♠ tricks.

This is one of the most misplayed positions in bridge. The usual approach is to lead the ♠Q, hoping that East holds the ♠K. But this can't succeed. If East does hold the ♠K he will cover, either this trick or the ♠J, and someone's ♠10 will become a winner. Of course if West has the ♠K then the finesse will fail, along with your chance of 2 more winners.

The correct way to play for 2 more tricks is to hope **WEST** has the ♠K and lead twice toward your ♠ Q J. So win the first trick, play ♠4 to dummy's ♠A. Lead the ♠3 toward your hand, playing the ♠J if West plays low. (Of course if West ever plays the ♠K he gives you two winners immediately.) When the ♠J wins, return to dummy with the ♦A and lead the ♠6 toward your ♠Q.

When West holds the ♠K you can always get 3 ♠ tricks if you play correctly.

Board 3
West Deals
E-W Vul

	North	
	♠ K 5 ♥ J 9 5 2 ♦ A 8 6 ♣ 9 7 6 3	
♠ 6 4 ♥ A 7 3 ♦ K Q 5 4 ♣ A K 8 2	N W E S	♠ Q J 9 8 7 3 ♥ K Q 6 ♦ 7 2 ♣ J 4
	♠ A 10 2 ♥ 10 8 4 ♦ J 10 9 3 ♣ Q 10 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1NT	Pass	4♠	
All Pass			

4♠ by East

HE WHO KNOWS, GOES You **KNOW** your side has 26-28 points. You **KNOW** your side has 8 or more ♠s. You **GO** to 4♠.

East plays 4♠. South leads the ♦J.

East plays 4♠. South leads the ♦J.

Losers: ♠ 2/3 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 0 : Total = 3/4

You are definitely going to lose the ♦A and the ♠ A K. Therefore you must plan to avoid losing a third ♠.

You should lead **UP TO** your honor cards. Cover the ♦J and lose to North's ♦A. Win his return (probably another ♦) in dummy. Lead a small ♠ to your ♠J. South wins with an honor and probably plays the ♦10. Ruff it, lead a ♣ to dummy and lead the last ♠. If North plays the other high honor you play low. If North plays low you guess whether to play the ♠K, or ♠10. Your best play is to assume the two honors were split and play the ♠Q.

Leading twice toward the ♠ Q J gives you a guarantee on this layout because North held a doubleton high honor.

Now

Here South has taken your ♠J with the ♠A. When you again lead a small ♠ from dummy say that North plays the ♠5.

You might think that South is just as likely to have held an original doubleton ♠ A K as doubleton ♠ A 10, and that playing the ♠9 would be as good a play as ♠Q.

This is untrue for a very classy-named reason - **The Principle of Restricted Choice**. You may not even believe it when you read it, but it's mathematically sound. If South were dealt an original ♠ A K, he would have been just as likely to win with the ♠K as with the ♠A. The fact that he actually won the ♠A makes it less likely that he also holds the ♠K.